

Chapter 19

AI in International Social Work and Global Issues



Fan Yang and Benjamin Lough

1 Introduction

1.1 Overview and Significance

Artificial intelligence (AI) is rapidly transforming various professional fields, including international social work. Defined broadly, AI refers to a suite of algorithmic computing capacities that perform tasks typically requiring human intelligence, such as commercial recommender systems, facial recognition, language processing, and sentiment analysis (Goldkind, 2021).

The relevance of AI to international social work has increased alongside the growing complexity and scale of global social challenges. International social work inherently deals with social issues that transcend national boundaries, such as forced migration, natural disasters, and pandemics. Social workers in international settings coordinate across diverse cultures, language barriers, legal systems, and administrative frameworks. Within this context, AI technologies offer unprecedented capabilities to address transnational social problems on a global scale. However, the application of AI in international contexts demands careful attention to cultural and ethical implications. This critical intersection between technology, ethics, and cultural competence forms a central theme of this chapter.

F. Yang (✉) · B. Lough

School of Social Work, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, Urbana, IL, USA

e-mail: fany16@illinois.edu; bjlough@illinois.edu

© The Author(s) 2026

R. An, M. A. Lindsey (eds.), *Artificial Intelligence in Social Work*,
https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-032-18443-6_19

427

1.2 Purpose of the Chapter

The purpose of this chapter is to critically examine the role of AI in addressing global social challenges. It aims to provide a balanced perspective by exploring both the potential of AI to improve responses to issues such as migration, refugee support, and global health and climate crisis and the risks it poses, including bias, data privacy concerns, and the reinforcement of structural inequalities. This chapter emphasizes the importance of culturally responsive usage and introduces ethical collaboration and decolonizing practices as essential pathways toward achieving cultural humility in international social work. Through real-world examples and critical analysis, it seeks to guide readers toward the responsible and inclusive integration of AI into international social work.

2 AI's Role in Addressing Global Challenges

AI has increasingly become a tool for tackling complex social problems that transcend borders. From managing migration flows to coordinating disaster relief and combating pandemics, AI technologies are being deployed to augment human efforts worldwide. This section explores three critical global challenges: migration and refugee crises, humanitarian aid in disasters, and international health emergencies and how AI offers innovative solutions in each. While highlighting the benefits of these AI-driven approaches, we also acknowledge the challenges that must be addressed, including data privacy, bias, and ethical dilemmas, setting the stage for a more detailed discussion of ethics later in the chapter.

2.1 Migration and Refugee Issues

AI is increasingly being utilized globally to enhance migration management and support services for refugees. In this context, AI primarily contributes through three significant applications: (1) predictive analytics, which enable the forecasting of migration flows and humanitarian needs, (2) AI-powered case management systems that effectively match refugees with essential services, and (3) AI-driven communication and assistance tools designed to improve interactions and facilitate access to support services for refugees.

Predictive analytics are employed to forecast migration flows and humanitarian needs, thereby enabling policymakers and aid organizations to prepare proactively. For instance, the Foresight project uses machine learning to analyze over 120 indicators and predict potential changes in migration patterns over time (Nair et al., 2023). These AI-driven models can identify tipping points and combinations of conflict, famine, or economic stress that may precipitate mass migration, thereby

facilitating earlier interventions. In East Africa, United Nations agencies have implemented similar approaches to anticipate displacement from regions such as Somalia by integrating climate and violence data, thereby transitioning humanitarian response from reactive to anticipatory.

AI-powered case management systems are being developed to enhance support for refugees by prioritizing vulnerable cases and matching them to appropriate services through data-driven algorithms. One notable example is GeoMatch, an AI-driven matching tool that recommends optimal resettlement locations for refugees (Achugamonu, 2025; Ferweda et al., 2022). Developed by researchers at Stanford's Immigration Policy Lab, GeoMatch analyzes refugees' background characteristics alongside historical integration outcomes, such as employment, to identify host communities where individuals are most likely to thrive. Notably, while the system supports decision-making, final determinations remain the responsibility of human case officers.

Another growing application is AI-driven communication and assistance tools for migrants and asylum seekers. Natural language processing and chatbot systems can help refugees navigate legal processes and access information. For instance, a WhatsApp-based chatbot called Sésamo was developed by the Sesame Workshop and the Norwegian Refugee Council to support Venezuelan migrant families (Ruvín, Hallie, 2021). This AI-powered chatbot provides easy access to educational content and vital information through mobile messaging, helping children and caregivers in displacement to learn and connect in their own language.

2.2 Humanitarian Aid and Disaster Response

AI is also transforming how social work professionals prepare for and respond to disasters and humanitarian crises worldwide. In disaster management, timing and information are everything. AI systems excel at rapidly analyzing data to support quick decision-making.

Machine learning models are increasingly being trained to predict events such as famines, floods, or conflict outbreaks before they occur, facilitating a shift from reactive relief to anticipatory action. For instance, humanitarian organizations employ predictive analytics to assess the potential impacts of drought on food security, enabling them to allocate aid—such as food supplies and cash assistance—before hunger sets in. This proactive approach enables aid organizations to mitigate the adverse effects of disasters by acting in advance (Jelonek, 2023).

During acute crises, AI technology significantly enhances situational awareness and damage assessment. Satellite imagery and computer vision are commonly utilized to map disaster impacts in real time. A notable initiative in this domain is the United Nations Global Pulse's PulseSatellite system, which integrates human analysis with AI-driven models to accelerate damage assessment. PulseSatellite can map structures within refugee settlements, detect roof damage, and segment flood extents from satellite imagery (Logar et al., 2020). This approach significantly

reduces the time required for manual counting and analysis, allowing humanitarian teams to quickly estimate the number of affected individuals and prioritize rescue operations. For example, during Cyclone Idai's flooding in Mozambique, AI-powered satellite mapping rapidly identified isolated communities, guiding helicopter relief missions (Charrua et al., 2021). Similarly, computer vision techniques have been employed to monitor refugee camps, including mapping tent locations and tracking camp growth, thereby informing camp management and infrastructure planning (Achugamonu, 2025; Ferweda et al., 2022).

These examples underscore the transformative potential of AI in enhancing the efficiency and effectiveness of humanitarian responses. Nonetheless, challenges persist. AI systems are only as good as the data they learn from; thus, in many low-income regions, data scarcity can limit model accuracy. As will be discussed later in this chapter, there are also concerns about the ethical use of AI. For instance, algorithms must be transparent and free of bias to ensure equitable aid so that no vulnerable group is left unseen by a "black-box" decision (Pasipamire & Muroyiwa, 2024). These issues are prompting initiatives to develop responsible AI guidelines for humanitarian use. Overall, AI's role in disaster relief is already proving transformative: enhancing early warning, sharpening situational awareness, and optimizing life-saving operations on a global scale.

2.3 Global Health Crises

Global health emergencies, such as pandemics, pose immense challenges that AI is increasingly helping address. In recent international health crises, from Ebola to COVID-19, AI tools have augmented epidemiological analysis, accelerated diagnostics, and supported healthcare delivery, especially in resource-strapped settings.

One key contribution of AI is in disease outbreak prediction and monitoring. Machine learning models have been employed to analyze extensive datasets, including online behavior and mobility data, to detect early signals of emerging epidemics. For instance, AI-based digital surveillance systems have been developed to detect early signs of outbreaks by processing open-source data, including news reports and social media data (MacIntyre et al., 2023). These systems can trigger early investigation, diagnostics, and responses at the regional level, complementing traditional research methods. Additionally, AI has been integrated into epidemic and pandemic early warning systems, identifying patterns in data that signal the onset of outbreaks. By analyzing travel and mobility data, AI can predict potential disease hotspots, model disease spread, and inform public health interventions (El Morr et al., 2024; Zhao et al., 2024).

Once a health crisis is underway, AI-powered diagnostics and screening become crucial. AI algorithms have demonstrated proficiency in analyzing medical images and other health data at speeds beyond those achievable by human experts alone. In the 2020 pandemic, AI models were used to read chest X-rays and CT scans for COVID-19 pneumonia signs, aiding radiologists in triaging patients when

thousands of scans needed review. Some hospitals deployed AI-driven thermal cameras and computer vision to identify people with fevers in crowds (Borkowski, 2020). In low-resource settings where doctors are scarce, these AI chatbots and diagnostic apps have become front-line tools for disseminating public health guidance and combating misinformation. Case studies from the Ebola response in West Africa similarly show AI's impact: a machine learning model used by UNICEF analyzed streams of text messages from the public to identify regions with spikes in certain Ebola symptoms, helping target community health outreach (Pasipamire & Muroyiwa, 2024).

On the healthcare delivery side, telehealth and telemedicine saw a boost from AI during global crises. AI-powered diagnostic tools have been deployed on tablets to assist community health workers in detecting diseases in diverse settings, from refugee camps to rural villages. These innovations have improved access to care, especially when traditional health systems are under strain. For instance, AI algorithms can rapidly assess and prioritize patients based on the severity of their conditions, aiding overwhelmed healthcare providers with effective triage and ensuring timely care for those in critical condition (Zuhair et al., 2024).

In summary, AI's role in global health crises has been multifaceted, strengthening preparedness, detection, and response. These benefits need to be weighed against challenges, including data privacy, algorithmic bias, and the need for validation to avoid false results. However, as later sections will discuss, with proper ethical guardrails, AI can be deployed responsibly in healthcare.

3 Key Risks and Barriers to Equitable AI Use in International Social Work

While AI holds promises for advancing social work globally, it also introduces significant challenges and risks. In international social work, these concerns are magnified. Key areas of caution include algorithmic bias and fairness, data privacy and security, and the digital divide and global inequities. Each of these issues can limit AI's usefulness and pose ethical dilemmas for practitioners. The following sections discuss these challenges, emphasizing their relevance to international social work and humanitarian contexts.

3.1 Bias and Fairness in Algorithms

One critical concern is the potential for AI systems to reinforce bias and discrimination. AI models learn from existing data, and if that data reflects historical prejudices or the underrepresentation of certain groups, the algorithms can reproduce and even amplify those biases (Reamer, 2023). In international social work, this

means an AI tool used for risk assessment or resource allocation might unfairly disadvantage marginalized communities. For instance, in international social work contexts involving refugees and immigrants, the use of AI in asylum and border management systems has raised significant ethical concerns. If AI algorithms inaccurately assess asylum seekers, they might be incorrectly returned to their countries of origin or sent to unsafe regions where they could face persecution or severe human rights violations, a harmful outcome known as *refoulement* (Forster & House, 2022).

Additionally, employing AI in asylum procedures raises critical issues regarding fairness and due process, potentially exacerbating existing structural inequities rather than alleviating them. Affected communities may be unable to interrogate, contest, or correct the algorithms and thus the decisions made “on their behalf,” thus further disempowering already marginalized groups. Biased algorithms could therefore unintentionally reinforce the very inequalities that international social work endeavors to eliminate. Moreover, in the context of global climate crises, AI systems designed to predict and manage disaster responses may not adequately account for the vulnerabilities of marginalized communities. Without careful design and oversight, these systems could allocate resources inequitably, exacerbating existing disparities. The International Committee of the Red Cross has emphasized the need to address risks, such as algorithmic bias and data privacy concerns, when deploying AI in humanitarian operations (Beduschi, 2022).

These examples underscore the necessity for rigorous evaluation and mitigation of biases in AI systems within international social work. In a global context, such biases may be exacerbated when AI tools developed in one cultural setting are applied in another. Ensuring that AI tools are equitable and bias-free requires continuous scrutiny and the implementation of measures to prevent the perpetuation of systemic inequalities (Reamer, 2023).

3.2 Data Privacy and Security

The integration of AI into international social work, particularly in contexts involving refugees, immigrants, climate change, and health crises, raises significant concerns about privacy, confidentiality, and data security. Social workers frequently handle sensitive personal information related to clients’ health, familial, and legal statuses. Integrating AI tools, such as predictive analytics or case management systems, may result in large amounts of client data being collected, stored, or analyzed digitally. Protecting this data is paramount. International social workers have an ethical duty to ensure that any AI software or platform they use has robust security measures: encryption, access controls, and protection against breaches (Reamer, 2023). Unauthorized access or cyberattacks could expose vulnerable populations to risks like identity theft, stigmatization, or persecution (Lubin, 2022). For instance, the leakage of information regarding a refugee’s location or a survivor of domestic violence’s shelter could result in severe harm. Adherence to social work ethical

codes globally underscores the importance of confidentiality; thus, the adoption of AI does not absolve professionals from this responsibility.

Privacy concerns are more complicated in international contexts where legal protections vary significantly. For example, in some countries, comprehensive data protection laws, such as the European Union's General Data Protection Regulation, provide strict guidelines on handling personal data, whereas other regions may have weak or nonexistent privacy regulations (Sartor & Lagioia, 2020). This inconsistency suggests that cross-border humanitarian projects using AI may operate in legal gray areas regarding data handling. Additionally, there exists the threat of surveillance and data misuse. Analyses caution that AI systems can be repurposed by third parties for surveillance without consent. Therefore, the security of data within AI systems transcends technical issues and becomes a matter of human rights (Ahmad, 2020). International social workers must exercise caution to ensure that the technologies they employ do not inadvertently expose clients to danger.

3.3 Digital Divide and Global Inequity

AI has the potential to exacerbate the existing digital divide and amplify global inequities. Access to AI technologies and the infrastructure is markedly uneven worldwide (Okolo, 2023). In high-income countries, fixed broadband costs constitute approximately 1% of monthly gross national income per capita. In contrast, in low-income countries, these costs can exceed 30% of the monthly gross national income per capita (Schellekens & Skilling, 2024). This significant disparity implies that AI-driven interventions, which often depend on reliable Internet connectivity and substantial computational resources, remain inaccessible to regions that could benefit most from them (Dychiao et al., 2024). Consequently, while wealthy nations advance in deploying AI across sectors such as healthcare, education, and social services, lower-income countries risk falling further behind, thereby missing out on the potential benefits of these technologies. This emerging AI divide threatens to deepen existing global inequalities (Berg et al., 2024). A United Nations report highlights that, without intentional efforts, high-income countries are poised to disproportionately reap AI's rewards, leaving developing nations at a disadvantage due to uneven investment and adoption (Berg et al., 2024). For instance, a social work agency in a well-resourced urban area might use AI to predict and prevent public health crises, whereas a similar agency in a low-resource setting cannot do so, thereby widening the disparity in community outcomes (Schellekens & Skilling, 2024; Vázquez & García, 2021).

Within individual countries, the digital divide further marginalizes rural and underserved populations by limiting their access to AI-assisted services (Perez et al., 2025). International social workers frequently serve refugees, disaster survivors, and individuals in remote areas where Internet and electricity access are unreliable. In such humanitarian contexts, the limitations of AI become particularly evident. AI tools typically require extensive data and stable connectivity—resources

are often scarce in crisis zones. Moreover, existing data in these settings may be incomplete or biased, undermining the effectiveness of AI applications (Maita et al., 2024). A study published in the *International Review of the Red Cross* emphasizes that “poor data quality generates poor outcomes that may directly affect populations in an already vulnerable situation due to conflicts or crises” (Beduschi, 2022). For example, if a disaster relief algorithm is trained predominantly on data from wealthier regions, it may fail to accurately prioritize needs across different cultural or economic contexts. AI is not a panacea for humanitarian challenges; in fact, it may create new forms of inequality if certain groups consistently benefit from AI-driven services while others are excluded.

Critically, this uneven distribution and utilization of AI technology must be understood within a broader context of global power dynamics. AI is built upon infrastructures and dependencies that reflect, and may reproduce, existing global power hierarchies. This critical frame recognizes that the development and deployment of AI is shaped by a transnational political economy dominated by powerful states, Big Tech monopolies, and venture capital interests. Embracing AI without interrogating these foundations risks aligning practice with the logics of technocratic control and risks complicity in the infrastructures that reproduce global inequality, including knowledge structures. This frame calls for social workers to decenter these dependencies. It also calls on us to balance the scale and speed that AI promises with the relational and justice-oriented practices that define the field.

4 Cultural Competence and Ethical Collaboration in AI-Driven International Social Work

As AI-driven interventions become more common in international social work, ensuring cultural competence and ethical practices is paramount. Cultural competence refers to the ability to understand and respect the values, norms, and needs of diverse populations (Cai, 2016). This section discusses how AI tools and programs can be developed and implemented to honor local cultures and empower communities. We highlight that effective AI for social good must be not only technologically sound but also culturally sensitive and ethically grounded. This ensures AI augments social work in an inclusive, fair manner that respects the dignity and agency of all communities served.

4.1 Importance of Cultural Competence in the Era of AI

In international social work, cultural competence is considered an essential pillar of effective and ethical practice. This concept emphasizes that social interventions must resonate with local values and traditions to succeed (Nadan, 2017). It signifies

a social worker's ability to appreciate and work within the cultural contexts of the communities they serve (Davis, 2020).

When introducing AI tools into international social work, the same principle applies: these technologies should be designed and adapted with a keen awareness of cultural differences. AI systems are not culturally neutral; everything from the data used to train them to the way their interface is presented carries assumptions that may or may not fit the local context (UNESCO, 2021). For example, a mental health support chatbot developed in one country might assume a direct communication style, but in another culture, people may prefer a more indirect or formal approach when discussing personal issues (Chin et al., 2023; Folk et al., 2025). Culturally competent AI design would take such scenarios into account—perhaps by adjusting language, adopting local idioms or symbols, and aligning with community norms of interaction.

Ensuring cultural relevance goes beyond mere language translation or superficial adjustments to imagery. It requires integrating AI systems with “indigenous” epistemological frameworks that reflect local ways of knowing and interpreting and aligning interventions with community norms, values, and social structures (Akter, 2024). In practice, this could mean engaging cultural advisors or representatives from the target community during the AI development process (Nadan, 2017). For instance, an AI-driven counseling app for refugees should reflect an understanding of the refugees' cultural background and trauma experiences, as well as their conceptions of healing and family, so that the recommendations it provides feel trustworthy. If an AI tool ignores cultural context, it risks imposing external values or misinterpreting users' needs, leading to low adoption or even harm. Thus, cultural competence acts as a quality check: AI solutions must be vetted for cultural sensitivity and appropriateness just as they are for technical accuracy. This means recognizing the diversity within cultural groups and avoiding stereotypes in algorithm design (Williams & Shipley, 2021). Ultimately, prioritizing cultural competence in AI-driven social work interventions helps ensure that technology augments rather than disrupts local practices and that communities feel respected and understood. This lays a foundation of trust, which is critical for any social program's success.

4.2 Ethical Collaboration with Communities

Achieving cultural competence and ethical AI deployment requires a sustained commitment to collaboration with local communities throughout every stage of development. Rather than imposing externally developed high-tech solutions, social workers and technologists are increasingly adopting participatory approaches that actively involve the people who will use or be affected by AI systems. This approach aligns with well-established traditions in international social work, such as participatory action research and community engagement, which emphasize shifting decision-making power to those most directly impacted by interventions (Bazzano et al., 2025). In the context of AI, participatory design entails involving community

members, front-line social workers, and local organizations in defining the problem, shaping the AI solution, and governing its implementation (Tan et al., 2025). By centering community voices and perspectives, the resulting AI tool is more likely to address genuine needs and gain community acceptance. For instance, when developing an AI system to allocate humanitarian aid in a specific region, a participatory approach would involve inviting local leaders and residents to share their insights on traditional aid distribution methods, local conceptions of fairness, and the outcomes that matter most to them. This inclusive process ensures that the algorithm's objectives and constraints are informed by community priorities, fostering an AI system that is contextually relevant and ethically sound (Okolo, 2023). By embedding participatory methodologies within AI development, implementation, and interpretation, social work practitioners and technologists not only enhance the relevance and acceptance of AI solutions but also uphold the fundamental principles of cultural competence and community self-determination.

Ethical collaboration also encompasses informed consent and transparency. Communities must be clearly informed about how an AI application functions, what data it collects and utilizes, and the intended purpose of its deployment. This information should be conveyed in a language and manner that is easily understood by community members (Nankya et al., 2025). Just as with any social intervention, practitioners must explain the objectives of the AI-driven program and obtain informed consent from the individuals or communities involved. Transparency also entails openly discussing the AI system's limitations and establishing a straightforward process for community feedback or complaints. One effective strategy could be creating community advisory boards specifically for AI projects. These advisory bodies can oversee project progress, address emerging concerns, and ensure that the technology remains accountable to the people it is intended to serve. Furthermore, international guidelines emphasize the necessity of diverse stakeholder participation to foster inclusive AI governance (UNESCO, 2021). This participatory approach ensures that AI systems are not only ethically sound but also practically relevant to the communities they serve.

4.3 Cultural Competence Training and Capacity Building

To ensure AI is used sustainably and equitably in international social work, cultural competence and capacity building are essential. This means training social workers to effectively engage with diverse communities, especially in contexts such as migration, health crises, and climate challenges, and to apply AI in ethical and culturally appropriate ways (Safodien, 2021). Capacity building empowers professionals and community leaders to use and oversee AI tools, reducing reliance on external experts. This begins with foundational AI literacy, which includes understanding fundamental AI concepts, how algorithms make decisions, and recognizing the strengths and limitations of these technologies (Mackline Nuwasiima et al., 2024).

Developing AI literacy allows social workers to critically assess AI outputs and make informed decisions, thereby maintaining professional judgment and ethical standards rather than passively accepting automated recommendations (Åhs et al., 2022).

Global initiatives increasingly recognize the importance of building digital and AI capacity among social workers and related professionals, especially in international social work. For instance, UNESCO has implemented digital capacity-building programs that include AI literacy components tailored for government and NGO staff, teachers, and educators in low-resource settings, often focusing on humanitarian contexts related to migration, disaster response, and public health emergencies (UNESCO Institute for Lifelong Learning, 2022a, 2022b). These programs use real-world scenarios, such as using AI to facilitate language learning for refugees or to prioritize healthcare interventions, to enhance participants' competencies in applying data-driven solutions effectively. In addition to structured training initiatives, practical on-the-job capacity building is critical. An effective approach involves embedding data scientists or IT specialists within social work teams to provide hands-on mentorship and support. A study highlights that embedding data science teams within specific departments fosters agility and cultivates specialized expertise, leading to more responsive and customized analytics outcomes (Stelmaszak & Kline, 2023). Additionally, fostering local technological talent with a focus on social impact can further enhance capacity.

Social work education institutions play a crucial role in preparing professionals to engage effectively with emerging technologies. Standards such as the Council on Social Work Education's 2022 Educational Policy and Accreditation Standards (EPAS) explicitly emphasize technological competence and ethical use of technology in social work practice (Council on Social Work Education, 2022). Aligning higher education curricula with these standards ensures social workers are better equipped to navigate and critically assess technological advancements. To further bridge theoretical learning and practical application, interdisciplinary university programs can be established to train future engineers and social workers collaboratively in "AI for social good" projects. Such interdisciplinary training cultivates a workforce that is not only technically proficient but also deeply attuned to community needs and ethical considerations. Continuous capacity building and professional development reinforce these skills, enabling social workers to effectively integrate AI technologies into practice while maintaining cultural competence and accountability to the communities they serve.

5 Decolonizing Practices: Toward Cultural Humility

Decolonizing practice is essential to achieving cultural humility in international social work, particularly in contexts involving migrants, refugees, climate crises, and health emergencies, as it moves beyond traditional cultural competence

frameworks that imply mastery rather than ongoing learning (Fong, 2001; Tamburro, 2013). Traditional cultural competence models often carry problematic assumptions, positioning practitioners as able to grasp or master another group's culture fully. This viewpoint inadvertently perpetuates hierarchical power dynamics, reinforcing Western-centric approaches and marginalizing local and Indigenous knowledge (Tamburro, 2013). Furthermore, existing social work theories, methodologies, and educational curricula predominantly originate from Western contexts, leading to the exclusion or marginalization of non-Western epistemologies. Such exclusion not only maintains existing global power imbalances but also limits the effectiveness and relevance of interventions in culturally diverse and resource-constrained settings (Bennett et al., 2024).

Additionally, the growing reliance on AI technologies, often developed and controlled by powerful global actors, risks amplifying existing inequalities and further excluding marginalized populations from equitable benefits. Thus, embracing decolonizing practices requires critically examining these embedded power structures, actively challenging knowledge exclusivity, promoting cultural humility, and authentically integrating local and Indigenous perspectives (Tamburro, 2013). By centering marginalized voices and acknowledging the complexities involved, social workers can better achieve equitable, culturally responsive, and justice-oriented practices.

Traditional cultural competence models often carry problematic assumptions, positioning practitioners as able to grasp or master another group's culture fully. This viewpoint inadvertently perpetuates hierarchical power dynamics, reinforcing Western-centric approaches and marginalizing local and Indigenous knowledge. Furthermore, existing social work theories, methodologies, and educational curricula predominantly originate from Western contexts, leading to the exclusion or marginalization of non-Western epistemologies. Such exclusion not only maintains existing global power imbalances but also limits the effectiveness and relevance of interventions in culturally diverse and resource-constrained settings. Additionally, the growing reliance on AI technologies, often developed and controlled by powerful global actors, risks amplifying existing inequalities and further excluding marginalized populations from equitable benefits. Thus, embracing decolonizing practices requires critically examining these embedded power structures, actively challenging knowledge exclusivity, promoting cultural humility, and authentically integrating local and Indigenous perspectives. By centering marginalized voices and acknowledging the complexities involved, social workers can better achieve equitable, culturally responsive, and justice-oriented practices.

This section explores decolonizing practice from two angles: (1) cultural humility and Indigenous knowledge, which involves ongoing learning, power-sharing, and valuing Indigenous worldviews, and (2) decolonizing data and technology, which emphasizes community data ownership and AI solutions driven by local needs. Together, these approaches push social work beyond cultural competence toward more inclusive, equitable practices.

5.1 *Cultural Humility and Integrating Indigenous Knowledge*

Decolonizing AI also necessitates embracing cultural humility, which involves recognizing the limitations of one's understanding of another culture and committing to continuous learning and power balancing. Unlike cultural competence, which implies mastery of cultural knowledge, cultural humility emphasizes ongoing self-reflection and the recognition of power imbalances. In social work, this means that technologists and practitioners must acknowledge their gaps in understanding the communities they serve (Ray, 2024). A culturally humble approach begins by asking fundamental questions like: "Should we build this AI system? If so, how can we co-design it with those who will use or be affected by it?"

Integrating Indigenous knowledge systems into AI development is a promising pathway. Indigenous epistemologies—ways of knowing developed over centuries—provide valuable perspectives that challenge Western paradigms (Williams & Shipley, 2021). In practice, this integration might involve consulting Indigenous elders during the design phase, incorporating community-defined data points such as traditional indicators into predictive models, or using local languages and concepts in AI interfaces.

Cultural humility within tech teams means deferring to Indigenous experts on what data is meaningful and what outcomes are desirable. Rather than imposing a generic risk score to predict which families need intervention, a culturally humble AI project in a First Nations context would begin by understanding how the community defines "risk" and "family well-being." This approach may reveal protective factors such as community cohesion or connection to land, which are often overlooked in Western models (Asakura et al., 2023). By learning from Indigenous frameworks and integrating AI with community practices of monitoring and mutual aid, technology becomes a tool that enhances local wisdom rather than overriding it.

Moreover, adopting cultural humility and valuing Indigenous knowledge inherently challenges technological solutionism, a belief that assumes complex social problems can be fully or adequately resolved through technological interventions, particularly advanced algorithms (Anka, 2024). Critiquing technological solutionism explicitly acknowledges that technology, especially AI, is neither universally applicable nor inherently neutral and emphasizes that many social issues require culturally informed approaches rather than purely technical solutions (Couldry & Mejias, 2019). Recognizing the limitations of technological approaches underscores the critical importance of genuinely empowering Indigenous communities, enabling their active participation and leadership in deliberations on the appropriateness, boundaries, and ethical implications of technology deployment within their unique contexts. Such involvement ensures technological interventions are culturally responsive, ethically grounded, and aligned with the priorities and values of Indigenous people.

Social workers using AI in international settings should act as facilitators or bridges rather than as authoritative technology implementers. Cultural humility of social workers can help resist the lure of technological solutionism. A humble stance

could involve co-training: social work professionals sharing AI literacy with community members while learning from them about local contexts (Hood et al., 2022). This reciprocal learning ensures that AI tools are continuously adapted to meet evolving community needs. Additionally, humility encourages openness to non-technological or hybrid solutions that blend traditional practices with modern technology, which may be more effective in some contexts (Anka, 2024).

In conclusion, decolonizing AI is not an abstract ideal; it is a practical pathway to better outcomes. It shifts power to communities, incorporates a broader range of human knowledge, and produces interventions that are ethical by design. As a result, AI tools developed in this way would better support the goals of international social work—promoting social justice, respecting cultural differences, and empowering communities toward sustainable change. Some argue that decolonizing AI also means recognizing that certain social problems should not be technologized at all, thus resisting the impulse to reduce complex moral and communal challenges to solvable technical issues.

5.2 *Decolonizing Data and Technology*

An antidote to digital colonialism is decolonizing AI from the ground up, particularly with respect to data ownership and the development process. Currently, AI development often mirrors historical patterns of resource extraction, where data is collected from marginalized communities without explicit consent or tangible benefits, a practice scholars refer to as data colonialism (Couldry & Mejias, 2019; Mannuru et al., 2023). For instance, social media or mobile data from communities in low-income countries may be used to train AI systems, or individuals from these regions may be hired for data labeling due to low labor costs. Yet, these communities seldom benefit from the resulting technologies, reflecting a pattern of exploitation that underscores the urgent need for ethical data practices and equitable benefit-sharing (Ateeq et al., 2024).

Decolonizing data and technology involves empowering communities to reclaim ownership, value, and contextual understanding of the data they generate. This approach is not merely an alternative to cultural competence; rather, it is fundamental for achieving authentic cultural competence through ongoing cultural humility and power-sharing. To decolonize technology, community-driven and community-owned approaches to AI development are paramount. Participatory algorithm design is a pivotal strategy that involves local community members in problem definition, setting success criteria, and testing algorithm outputs. This collaborative approach transforms AI from a black-box tool imposed on communities to a co-created asset that reflects their priorities and lived experiences (Williams & Shipley, 2021). This could mean a refugee community helping to develop an algorithm for resource allocation in camps, ensuring it reflects their priorities and lived realities, and ensuring that AI technologies align with community values and ethical considerations.

Data sovereignty is a critical principle in decolonizing AI, asserting that communities, especially Indigenous and marginalized populations, have the inherent right to govern the collection, storage, and utilization of their data. This principle emphasizes that data ownership should remain with the community rather than being exploited by external entities. One challenge is that existing AI ethics frameworks are often rooted in Western values, prioritizing individual autonomy and data privacy while neglecting the communalist perspectives predominant in many regions of the Global South. For example, in African contexts, data governance is embedded in relational ethics; community well-being and collective ownership are often valued over individual rights, making it essential to reinterpret AI ethics frameworks in ways that resonate with local values and cultural norms (Grancia, 2024). This cultural mismatch underscores the importance of developing region-specific guidelines that reflect the lived realities and priorities of local populations, particularly when addressing pressing healthcare challenges. Community oversight is essential to ensuring data sovereignty and making sure that AI serves the interests of those who provide the data.

Ultimately, decolonizing technology involves fundamentally disrupting power dynamics—from AI being imposed upon communities to AI being co-created by them. While co-creation is essential, achieving meaningful change requires deeper structural, societal, and systemic engagement. Although this approach may take more time, the additional effort yields tools that are more contextually appropriate and ethically grounded.

6 Responsible AI: Future Directions for International Social Work

AI presents significant potential for addressing complex global social issues, yet its deployment in international contexts introduces unique ethical, cultural, and practical challenges. To maximize AI's positive impact while mitigating risks, future strategies must focus on refining ethical governance, strengthening professional competencies, promoting inclusive participatory design processes, and enhancing data management infrastructures.

6.1 Ethical Guidelines, Governance, and Advocacy

As AI becomes increasingly embedded in international social work, robust ethical guidelines and governance frameworks are essential to ensure these technologies align with core social work values and responsible use. Currently, the landscape is fragmented, with scattered principles like the “AI for Good” pledges or general technology ethics codes in social work. International social work would greatly

benefit from tailored standards that address the unique challenges of social services and humanitarian contexts worldwide.

One notable model to build on is the global effort by UNESCO, which released the first international standard on AI ethics in 2021, the *Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence*, which emphasizes human rights, fairness, and human oversight (UNESCO, 2021). In addition to UNESCO's foundational standards, social work professionals can draw on existing ethics-informed guidelines specifically developed within the field. These frameworks address three primary domains: practice standards, regulatory and licensing standards, and codes of ethics standards (Reamer, 2023). In 2013, recognizing the need for structured guidance on emerging technologies, the Association of Social Work Boards (ASWB) appointed an international task force comprising representatives from diverse areas of social work practice, regulation, and education. By 2015, the task force had developed and adopted detailed ethics guidelines specifically for social workers engaging with digital and electronic technologies. These guidelines emphasized seven core ethical areas that are especially relevant to AI integration into international social work practice: practitioner competence; informed consent; privacy and confidentiality; boundaries, dual relationships, and conflicts of interest; records and documentation; collegial relationships; and social work practice across jurisdictional boundaries (López Peláez & Kirwan, 2023). Building on this foundation, further progress in ethical standard-setting occurred in 2017 through unprecedented collaboration among key U.S. social work organizations, ASWB, the National Association of Social Workers (NASW), Council on Social Work Education (CSWE), and the Clinical Social Work Association (CSWA). These entities worked together to develop comprehensive practice standards that included detailed ethical considerations for the use of technology within social work. The resulting standards addressed critical ethical areas, including informed consent, competent practice, conflicts of interest, privacy and confidentiality, boundaries and professional relationships, record-keeping, and supervision (NASW et al., 2017).

While these frameworks provide valuable guidance, it is essential to acknowledge their limitations. First, many operate primarily as aspirational guidelines rather than enforceable regulations. Building on these foundational ethical guidelines, it is crucial to recognize that although existing frameworks offer a solid foundation, they should not be simply imported from the outside. Instead, they must emerge organically from communities and professional organizations within the Global South, reflecting local realities and knowledge systems. Unlike domestic contexts, international social work often involves complex, dynamic situations involving refugees, immigrants, climate crises, and global health emergencies (Payne & Askeland, 2016). Ethical guidelines developed through a bottom-up approach are better positioned to address the unique challenges of international social work contexts. In refugee and immigrant settings, informed consent should be transparent and culturally sensitive, taking into account language barriers and differing norms. In climate crisis zones, AI-driven decisions must account for disrupted infrastructure and data gaps. During global health emergencies, such as pandemics, data sharing raises

confidentiality concerns, requiring strong security to prevent misuse. Social workers must critically assess AI outcomes to ensure context-aware, responsible implementation that prioritizes local leadership and community-driven processes.

Without concrete oversight and accountability mechanisms, particularly in transnational contexts, ethical commitments risk becoming symbolic rather than impactful. This situation can lead to “ethical laundering,” where superficial compliance masks potentially harmful or inequitable technological practices. Ethical codes are generally unenforceable, especially across transnational contexts with varying governance structures and legal frameworks. Without clear accountability mechanisms, usually established at localized levels, these codes risk serving more as virtue signaling than as genuine safeguards. Second, the majority of these standards originate from institutions and professional bodies based in the Global North. As a result, they often reflect Northern-centric norms and regulatory priorities that may not align with the cultural values, social realities, or infrastructural conditions of communities in the Global South. These limitations highlight the need for more inclusive, enforceable, and locally grounded frameworks that better reflect the diversity of international practice contexts. Given these limitations, it is necessary to move from a one-size-fits-all ethical approach to one that is responsive to specific practice contexts.

Ultimately, addressing critical limitations—such as the lack of enforceability and Northern-centric biases—while ensuring careful cultural localization of ethical guidelines is essential to support responsible AI use in international social work effectively. Comprehensive guidelines that incorporate enforceable accountability mechanisms and context-specific cultural adaptations will more effectively promote social justice, resilience, and global equity, thereby mitigating rather than exacerbating existing inequalities.

6.2 Capacity Building and Training for International Social Workers

To integrate AI responsibly, both social workers and technologists need training that builds mutual understanding. Social workers should gain basic AI literacy to evaluate technologies critically, while technologists must learn about social work values and contexts. Joint training programs and co-design workshops can foster collaboration, critical thinking, and community-aligned solutions. Additionally, in the future, formal education curricula in social work should incorporate modules on AI ethics, digital literacy, and practical skills for evaluating AI systems (Hodgson et al., 2022; Reamer, 2023; Safodien, 2021). Universities and professional training organizations could collaborate with tech companies and international NGOs to offer certification programs specifically focused on ethical AI integration (Council on Social Work Education, 2022; National Association of Social Workers et al., 2017). Continuous professional development should also be encouraged through regular

updates and refresher training on emerging technologies and their ethical implications. Creating an international exchange program for social workers and technologists can further enhance knowledge transfer and cultural competency, thereby ensuring AI solutions are globally informed and locally relevant.

6.3 Inclusive and Participatory Design with Strengthened Data Infrastructure

Inclusive and participatory design is a cornerstone of responsible AI in social work. This approach involves co-developing tools with the communities they aim to serve, ensuring that AI solutions are both relevant and culturally appropriate (Sabater et al., 2025). Community stakeholders should be involved from the start to ensure AI tools reflect local needs. Strong, locally controlled data systems are key to ethical AI use, helping prevent misuse and ensuring accuracy. Building local data capacity and using federated learning can enhance data sovereignty. Clear guidelines on data ownership and consent are also essential. Communities should have transparent control over their data, including the ability to access, correct, and withdraw their data from AI systems (Tan et al., 2025). Building robust governance structures, such as community advisory boards, can facilitate ongoing dialogue between stakeholders, enhancing accountability and trust. Regular audits and evaluations of AI systems by independent bodies can further ensure ethical compliance and effectiveness. To be meaningful, however, participatory design must be adequately resourced. Funders and NGOs must also be willing to retool timelines and metrics to value long-term engagement and locally defined outcomes. Ultimately, empowering communities with the skills and resources necessary to participate meaningfully in AI development will foster inclusive, equitable, and sustainable outcomes in international social work contexts.

In conclusion, integrating AI into international social work offers significant potential to address global challenges. However, achieving responsible and ethical AI use requires clear, enforceable guidelines tailored to international contexts. These guidelines must be culturally responsive, inclusive, and uphold accountability to bridge ethical gaps and mitigate biases effectively. Additionally, building professional competence through targeted AI literacy for social workers and social work training for technologists is essential. Joint educational initiatives and continuous learning opportunities will foster interdisciplinary collaboration and ethical practice. Finally, inclusive participatory design, supported by robust local data infrastructures, ensures that AI solutions are relevant and equitable. Meaningful community involvement and transparent data governance empower communities and build trust, resulting in fairer and more effective outcomes. By prioritizing ethical standards, capacity building, and inclusive design, international social work can harness AI responsibly to advance global social justice and equity.

Competing Interests The authors have no conflicts of interest to declare that are relevant to the content of this chapter.

References

- Achugamonu, S. (2025). *Place matters: The possibilities and pitfalls of machine learning algorithms for refugee resettlement*.
- Ahmad, N. (2020). Refugees and algorithmic humanitarianism: Applying artificial intelligence to RSD procedures and immigration decisions and making global human rights obligations relevant to AI governance. *International Journal on Minority and Group Rights*, 1(aop), 1–69.
- Åhs, F., Mozelius, P., Espvall, M., & Se, P. M. (2022). *Preparing psychologists and social workers for the daily use of AI*.
- Akter, S. (2024). Global perspectives on the social impacts of artificial intelligence: A comparative review of regional inequalities and cultural contexts. *Journal of Artificial Intelligence General Science*, 5(1).
- Anka, A. (2024). Using the concept of epistemic injustice and cultural humility for understanding why and how social work curricular might be decolonized. *Social Work Education*. <https://doi.org/10.1080/02615479.2023.2299245>
- Asakura, K., Miller, J., Nakash, O., & O'Neill, P. (2023). Toward “decolonizing” clinical social work practice and education. In *Smith college studies in social work* (Vol. 93, Issues 2–4, pp. 73–82). Routledge. <https://doi.org/10.1080/00377317.2023.2279389>
- Ateeq, A., Ahmed Ali, S., Milhem, M., Alzoraik, M., Ateeq, R. A., & Al Asta, A. Y. (2024). Exploring the reality of artificial intelligence in the developing countries: Challenges and opportunities – a scientific perspective. *Pakistan Journal of Life and Social Sciences (PJLSS)*, 22(1). <https://doi.org/10.57239/pjls-2024-22.1.00144>
- Bazzano, A. N., Mantsios, A., Mattei, N., Kosorok, M. R., & Culotta, A. (2025). AI can be a powerful social innovation for public health if community engagement is at the core. *Journal of Medical Internet Research*, 27, e68198. <https://doi.org/10.2196/68198>
- Beduschi, A. (2022). Harnessing the potential of artificial intelligence for humanitarian action: Opportunities and risks. *International Review of the Red Cross*, 104(919), 1149–1169.
- Berg, J., Snene, M., & Velasco, L. (2024). *Mind the AI divide: Shaping a global perspective on the future of work*. United Nations. <https://www.ilo.org/publications/major-publications/mind-ai-divide-shaping-global-perspective-future-work>
- Bennett, B., Redfern, H., & Zubrzycki, J. (2024). How do we decolonise the social work curriculum? *Australian Social Work*, 77(1), 1–13. <https://doi.org/10.1080/0312407X.2024.2329233>
- Borkowski, A. (2020). Using artificial intelligence for COVID-19 chest X-ray diagnosis. *Federal Practitioner*, 37(9). <https://doi.org/10.12788/fp.0045>
- Cai, D. Y. (2016). A concept analysis of cultural competence. *International Journal of Nursing Sciences*, 3(3), 268–273. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijnss.2016.08.002>
- Charrua, A. B., Padmanaban, R., Cabral, P., Bandeira, S., & Romeiras, M. M. (2021). Impacts of the tropical cyclone Idai in Mozambique: A multi-temporal landsat satellite imagery analysis. *Remote Sensing*, 13(201).
- Chin, H., Song, H., Baek, G., Shin, M., Jung, C., Cha, M., Choi, J., & Cha, C. (2023). The potential of chatbots for emotional support and promoting mental well-being in different cultures: Mixed methods study. *Journal of Medical Internet Research*, 25, e51712. <https://doi.org/10.2196/51712>
- Council on Social Work Education. (2022). *2022 Educational Policy and Accreditation Standards (EPAS)*. Council on Social Work Education. <https://www.csw.org/getmedia/bb5d8afe-7680-42dc-a332-a6e6103f4998/2022-EPAS.pdf>

- Couldry, N., & Mejias, U. A. (2019). Data colonialism: Rethinking big data's relation to the contemporary subject. *Television & New Media*, 20(4), 336–349.
- Davis, M. (2020). The “culture” in cultural competence. In *Cultural competence and the higher education sector: Australian perspectives, policies and practice* (pp. 15–29). Springer Singapore. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-981-15-5362-2_2
- Dychiao, R. G., Nazer, L., Mlombwa, D., & Celi, L. A. (2024). Artificial intelligence and global health equity. *BMJ*, 387.
- El Morr, C., Ozdemir, D., Asdaah, Y., Saab, A., El-Lahib, Y., & Sokhn, E. S. (2024). AI-based epidemic and pandemic early warning systems: A systematic scoping review. *Health Informatics Journal*, 30(3). <https://doi.org/10.1177/14604582241275844>
- Ferweda, J., Finseraas, H., & Christensen, D. A. (2022). *The feasibility of using data-driven algorithmic recommendations for refugee placement in Norway*.
- Folk, D., Wu, C., & Heine, S. (2025). Culture and chatbots: Cultural variation in attitudes towards social chatbots. *Journal of Cross-Cultural Psychology*.
- Fong, R. (2001). Culturally competent practice: What is it and why does it matter? *Journal of Ethnic & Cultural Diversity in Social Work*, 10(1), 1–10. https://doi.org/10.1300/J051v10n01_01
- Forster, M., & House, C. (2022). Refugee protection in the artificial intelligence era. *Research Paper*.
- Goldkind, L. (2021). Social work and artificial intelligence: Into the matrix. *Social Work (United States)*, 66(4), 372–374. <https://doi.org/10.1093/sw/swab028>
- Grancia, M. K. (2024). Decolonizing AI ethics in Africa's healthcare: An ethical perspective. *AI and Ethics*. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s43681-024-00650-z>
- Hodgson, D., Goldingay, S., Boddy, J., Nipperess, S., & Watts, L. (2022). Problematising artificial intelligence in social work education: Challenges, issues and possibilities. *The British Journal of Social Work*, 52(4), 1878–1895.
- Hood, S., Campbell, B., & Baker, K. (2022). *Culturally informed community engagement: Implications for inclusive science and health equity*. <https://doi.org/10.3768/rtipress.2023.op.0083.2301>
- Jelonek, A. C. (2023). *Use of predictive analytics in humanitarian operations*. Fordham University.
- Logar, T., Bullock, J., Nemni, E., Bromley, L., Quinn, J. A., & Luengo-Oroz, M. (2020). *PulseSatellite: A tool using human-AI feedback loops for satellite image analysis in humanitarian contexts*. <https://ojs.aaai.org/index.php/AAAI/article/view/7101>
- López Peláez, A., & Kirwan, G. (Eds.). (2023). *The Routledge international handbook of digital social work*. Routledge.
- Lubin, A. (2022). The rights to privacy and data protection under international humanitarian law and human rights law. In *Research handbook on human rights and humanitarian law* (pp. 462–491). Edward Elgar.
- MacIntyre, C. R., Chen, X., Kunasekaran, M., Quigley, A., Lim, S., Stone, H., Paik, H. Y., Yao, L., Heslop, D., Wei, W., Sarmiento, I., & Gurdasani, D. (2023). Artificial intelligence in public health: The potential of epidemic early warning systems. *Journal of International Medical Research*, 51(3). <https://doi.org/10.1177/03000605231159335>
- Maita, K. C., Forte, A. J., Demaerschalk, B. M., Coffey, J. D., Lunde, J. J., Borna, S., Torres-Guzman, R. A., Maniaci, M. J., Haider, C. R., & Avila, F. R. (2024). The impact of digital health solutions on bridging the health care gap in rural areas: A scoping review. *The Permanente Journal*, 28(3), 130–143.
- Mannuru, N. R., Shahriar, S., Teel, Z. A., Wang, T., Lund, B. D., Tijani, S., Pohboon, C. O., Agbaji, D., Alhassan, J., Galley, J. K., Kousari, R., Ogbadu-Oladapo, L., Saurav, S. K., Srivastava, A., Tummuru, S. P., Uppala, S., & Vaidya, P. (2023). Artificial intelligence in developing countries: The impact of generative artificial intelligence (AI) technologies for development. *Information Development*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/02666669231200628>
- Nadan, Y. (2017). Rethinking ‘cultural competence’ in international social work. *International Social Work*, 60(1), 74–83. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0020872814539986>

- Nankya, H., Mathews, D., Ferryman, K., Kane, O., & Ali, J. (2025). Community engagement for artificial intelligence health research in Africa. *Wellcome Open Research*, 10, 158. <https://doi.org/10.12688/wellcomeopenres.23684.1>
- Nair, R., Madsen, B., & Kjærum, A. (2023). An explainable forecasting system for humanitarian needs assessment. In *Proceedings of the AAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence* (Vol. 37, No. 13, pp. 15569–15575).
- National Association of Social Workers, Clinical Social Work Association, Council on Social Work Education, & Association of Social Work Boards. (2017). *NASW, ASWB, CSWE, & CSWA standards for technology in social work practice*. National Association of Social Workers. <https://www.socialworkers.org/Practice/NASW-Practice-Standards-Guidelines/Standards-for-Technology-in-Social-Work-Practice>
- Nuwasiima, M., Ahonon, M. P., & Kadiri, C. (2024). The role of artificial intelligence (AI) and machine learning in social work practice. *World Journal of Advanced Research and Reviews*, 24(1), 80–97. <https://doi.org/10.30574/wjarr.2024.24.1.2998>
- Okolo, C. T. (2023). Addressing global inequity in AI development. In *Handbook of critical studies of artificial intelligence* (pp. 378–389). Edward Elgar.
- Pasipamire, N., & Muroyiwa, A. (2024). Navigating algorithm bias in AI: Ensuring fairness and trust in Africa. *Frontiers in Research Metrics and Analytics*, 9. <https://doi.org/10.3389/frma.2024.1486600>
- Payne, M., & Askeland, G. A. (2016). *Globalization and international social work: Postmodern change and challenge*. Routledge.
- Perez, K., Wisniewski, D., Ari, A., Lee, K., Lieneck, C., & Ramamonjiravelo, Z. (2025). Investigation into application of AI and telemedicine in rural communities: A systematic literature review. *Healthcare (Switzerland)*, 13(3). <https://doi.org/10.3390/healthcare13030324>
- Ray, S. (2024). *Incorporating indigenous knowledge systems into AI governance: Enhancing ethical frameworks with Maori and Navajo perspectives*. <https://doi.org/10.20944/preprints202410.2112.v2>
- Reamer, F. G. (2023). Artificial intelligence in social work: Emerging ethical issues. *International Journal of Social Work Values and Ethics*, 20(2), 52–71.
- Rubin, H. (2021). *Sesame workshop announces new tools to support children and families impacted by the Venezuelan crisis*. Sesame Workshop.
- Sabater, A., López, B., Campdepadrós, R., & Sánchez, C. (2025). Participatory action research for AI in social services: An example of local practices from Catalonia. In P. Ahrweiler (Ed.), *Participatory artificial intelligence in public social services: From bias to fairness in assessing beneficiaries* (pp. 79–96). Springer Nature Switzerland. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-71678-2_4
- Safodien, M. (2021). Social work 4.0? The Fourth Industrial Revolution and social work education: A South African perspective. *Social Work*, 57(3), 257–271.
- Sartor, G., & Lagioia, F. (2020). *The impact of the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) on artificial intelligence*.
- Schellekens, P., & Skilling, D. (2024). *Three reasons why AI may widen global inequality*. Center for Global Development.
- Stelmaszak, M., & Kline, K. (2023). Managing embedded data science teams for success: How managers can navigate the advantages and challenges of distributed data science. *Harvard Data Science Review*, 5(2). <https://doi.org/10.1162/99608f92.1f068331>
- Tamburro, A. (2013). Including decolonization in social work education and practice. *Journal of Indigenous Social Development*, 2(1), 1–16.
- Tan, Y., Soh, K., Zhang, R., Lee, J., Meng, H., Sen, B., & Lee, Y.-C. (2025). *Empowering social service with AI: Insights from a participatory design study with practitioners*. <https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2502.19822>
- UNESCO. (2021). *Recommendation on the ethics of artificial intelligence*. <https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/48223/pf0000381137>

- UNESCO Institute for Lifelong Learning. (2022a). *From radio to artificial intelligence: Review of innovative technology in literacy and education for refugees, migrants and internally displaced persons*. UNESCO. <https://doi.org/10.54675/KZHI8494>
- UNESCO Institute for Lifelong Learning. (2022b). *Leveraging innovative technology in literacy and education programmes for refugees, migrants and internally displaced persons*. UNESCO. <https://doi.org/10.54675/IMHD4511>
- Vázquez González, S. & García Rendón, O.L. (Eds.) (2021). *Desafíos del trabajo social digital en Latinoamérica*. Thomson Reuters Aranzadi
- Williams, D., & Shipley, G. (2021). Enhancing artificial intelligence with indigenous wisdom. *Open Journal of Philosophy*, 11, 43–58.
- Zhao, A. P., Li, S., Cao, Z., Hu, P. J.-H., Wang, J., Xiang, Y., Xie, D., & Lu, X. (2024). AI for science: Predicting infectious diseases. *Journal of Safety Science and Resilience*, 5(2), 130–146. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jnlssr.2024.02.002>
- Zuhair, V., Babar, A., Ali, R., Oduoye, M. O., Noor, Z., Chris, K., Okon, I. I., & Rehman, L. U. (2024). Exploring the impact of artificial intelligence on global health and enhancing healthcare in developing nations. *Journal of Primary Care and Community Health*, 15. <https://doi.org/10.1177/21501319241245847>

Open Access This chapter is licensed under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International License (<http://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/>), which permits use, sharing, adaptation, distribution and reproduction in any medium or format, as long as you give appropriate credit to the original author(s) and the source, provide a link to the Creative Commons license and indicate if changes were made.

The images or other third party material in this chapter are included in the chapter's Creative Commons license, unless indicated otherwise in a credit line to the material. If material is not included in the chapter's Creative Commons license and your intended use is not permitted by statutory regulation or exceeds the permitted use, you will need to obtain permission directly from the copyright holder.



Part IV
AI in Social Work Education and Research